SPOAcademy

CATALYST PROJECT 1200212

Project Completion Report

SPO Academy: Business Education for Stake Pool Operators

8	9	5
modules, 000 to 700	confirmed cohort participants	live sessions delivered

DELIVERED BY FLUID7 LTD WITH EDIFY 27 OCTOBER 2026

THE PROBLEM THIS PROJECT ADDRESSED

Stake pool operators are, as a population, technically excellent and commercially invisible. Most can build and run infrastructure. Far fewer can say what their pool is for, who it serves, what value it creates, or how it survives.

SPO Academy was funded to close that gap with a business course written for operators, delivered on-chain, with a credential at the end.

PROJECT DETAILS

Project name	**SPO Academy: Business Education for Stake Pool Operators**
Project number	1200212
Project manager	Jonathan Adjei, Fluid7 Ltd
Delivery partner	Harry Hellyer, Edify Systems Limited, trading as Edify Colabs
Project start date	12 August 2024. Delivery resumed 28 August 2025 after a pause
Project completion date	26 October 2026
Project URL	milestones.projectcatalyst.io/projects/1200212
All outputs	catalyst.pages.fluid7.co.uk/spoacademydocs
Completion video	youtu.be/0nnG3V2Fl38

Deliverables 01

OUTPUT	WHAT IT IS	EVIDENCE
The course	Eight modules, 000 to 700, orientation through to a finished business plan	app.andamio.io/course/spo-academy
On-chain credentials	Eight credentials, one per module, all minted on Cardano in a single transaction and claimable by the operator	Transaction hashes in Milestone 4 Output E
The Playbook Builder	Assembles a participant's assignment answers into a usable plan, copied out in one click	Demonstrated in the completion video
Public website and application flow	Course marketing, the persona quiz, and on-chain pool verification at application	spo.academy
Live delivery	An onboarding session and four teaching sessions, each recorded and written up the same week	Cohort session write-ups
Pricing model	Adopted 5 October 2026, with the market research behind each price	Pricing strategy
Feedback instrument and findings	A seven-question form with a three-way quoting-consent item, plus the compiled analysis	Feedback report

Testing performed. The course was run live with a real cohort of nine operators across five sessions. Pool identifiers and Calidus IDs are verified against the Cardano chain at application. The credential path was exercised end to end, from course creation through to a participant claim, with the transactions recorded on chain.

User feedback. Three written responses to the feedback form, all three consenting to attribution, plus a verbal round in the final session and continuous feedback in the cohort Discord. Compiled in the feedback report, with every resulting action owned and dated in the action plan.

Open source status and licence. Yes. Code under **Apache License 2.0**, course packaging under **CC BY-SA 4.0**. Edify Systems Limited's frameworks and assignment templates stay proprietary, so the public Playbook Builder ships placeholder prompts. See each repository's NOTICE.

On-chain evidence

Andamio course id

e60f29abf7a3f348bf4f51a078dae6f53cd3bc065d74632d3f67d785

Andamio credential policy id, shared across their courses

26a8cd75574c11bf33e85e69134529f765cf1e1743d33e89b61da9c5

Course access token minted, 11 February 2026

51ab905a2c02ca06361b6bde8044b8cb018a51d4ccf98b68ca7ed85b86ccd0e1

All eight module credentials minted, 31 July 2026

aa72a10e10dbc0c416f1bb738a4374844b697ff6b83a7f91dedf9f1917269655

An assignment submitted against the module 000 credential, 29 September 2026

9c95a94aaa10507f717c5fbd9edec4ac6e126837bb4000ef958d33ad9716feee

Usage

02

9
Confirmed cohort participants

14
Operators who identified themselves to the project, of whom 10 came through the persona quiz

5
Live sessions delivered, including onboarding

13
Assignments completed and accepted, 2 still in assessment

31
Assignments submitted, by 6 of the 9 participants

3 of 9
Written feedback responses

56
Campaign items published, each with a posted reference

Who uses it. Cardano stake pool operators, mainnet and testnet. The cohort included established operators, one running five years, and prospective operators without a mainnet pool yet, which the course was deliberately built to serve.

Key actions completed by users. Minting an Andamio access token, working the module assignments against their own pool, building a plan in the Playbook Builder, claiming an on-chain credential, and submitting written feedback.

Evidence of engagement. Each session has a published write-up and recording. Participants submitted assignments between sessions, raised platform friction in the cohort channel as it happened, and two have described continuing to build their plan after the cohort closed. Completion ran ahead of claiming: operators did the work and left the credential unclaimed, which is the same signal as their strongest product ask. A credential is worth claiming when there is somewhere to show it.

Impact

03

WHAT CHANGED FOR THE OPERATORS

Every form respondent reported an unprompted shift in how they think about their pool, and all three said the plan they built is one they will use. One had already started an evolving playbook for their own pool. One stated they will execute on the plan.

> **Previously, it was easy to focus on increasing delegation, producing blocks and maintaining reliable infrastructure. Those things remain important, but I'm increasingly viewing delegation growth as a possible outcome of creating meaningful value rather than the primary reason for operating the pool.**
>
> — RCADA

Asked in the final session what the course changed for them, the answers were:

- → seeing the gaps in how a pool measures the value it creates;
- → the difference between a pool's philosophy and the systems that run it;
- → thinking of a pool as an organism rather than a machine;
- → the pool's financial gaps and the types of delegator it serves;
- → and, for a five-year operator, putting words to the personal development the work has brought.

BEFORE AND AFTER

Before this project there was no business-focused course for Cardano stake pool operators, and no on-chain credential for one. There is now, with nine operators through it and the material permanently available and self-paced.

Benefit to the Cardano ecosystem

Small pools that can articulate their purpose and sustain themselves are what keeps the network decentralised. The course also put Andamio's credentialing through a full live cohort and fed detailed findings back to their team, who asked for them and acted on them. Every course built on that platform benefits from that round trip.

Partnerships and recognition

Delivered with Edify. The course was presented in person to the xSPO Alliance weekly call on 4 October 2026, and announced across the Andamio, SPO Call, xSPO Alliance, RealFi, IOG / Intersect and Midnight communities.

Sustainability 04

The project is ongoing, not a one-off.

Maintenance model. The course stays open and self-paced on Andamio. Fluid7 maintains the public site, the application flow and the Playbook Builder. The seventeen improvements in the action plan each carry an owner and a date.

REVENUE MODEL · ADOPTED 5 OCTOBER 2026

$295
for a guided cohort

$210
self-paced

Operator-set price
for pools estimated to earn under 5,000 ADA a year

The launch cohort was not charged, so these prices are published but untested. **The second cohort has to charge for that to change.**

FUTURE ROADMAP

A second cohort once the material is reworked, a dedicated session with Andamio to get the platform items onto their roadmap, and the credentials package the cohort asked for. A further live session for this cohort may be arranged once the updated material is ready.

Milestones and outcomes

1	2	3	4
Course Foundation and User Experience Design	Technical Infrastructure and Content Development	Platform Enhancement and Course Content Finalization	Platform Launch, Community Engagement, and Project Evaluation
Approved 7 March 2025	Approved 17 September 2025	Approved 15 September 2026	This milestone

MVP EVALUATED AGAINST THE PRE-DEFINED CRITERIA

Treasury system operational	MET	Live on chain
Minimum 15 SPOs confirmed for the initial run	NOT MET	Nine confirmed
Pricing model defined and published	MET	Adopted 5 October, with the research behind each price
Promotional materials across X, LinkedIn and SPO Discord communities	MET	Fifty-six items, each with a posted reference
Certification NFTs minted on chain, pool specific	MET	Minted and claimed, with transaction hashes
Participant feedback collected and analysed, improvements identified	MET	Three written responses, a verbal round, seventeen owned actions
Close-out report and video	PUBLISHED	With the video to follow

ON THE PARTICIPANT COUNT

9 / 15

Nine against a target of fifteen is the one criterion missed. Marketing was not the constraint.

Fourteen operators gave their contact details, ten through the persona quiz alone, across fifty-six published campaign items. The constraint was conversion from interest to commitment. A stake pool operator is usually a sole trader running infrastructure in the evenings, and a four-session course asking for written assignments about their own business is a real ask.

The nine who committed produced more usable evidence than fifteen passive enrolments would have.

Lessons learned

1 **A cohort target is a conversion assumption, not a marketing one.**

We reached operators comfortably and converted fewer than planned. The next target should be set on how many operators will commit to assignments, not on how many will give an email address.

2 **Choosing a platform is choosing a partner.**

Andamio gave us on-chain credentials we could not have built in the budget, and a team that answered. Participants still hit friction: submission costs the platform did not surface, a module stuck in assessment, no resume between modules. Andamio asked for the detail and shipped fixes while the cohort was still running. The rest are on their roadmap. Friction is inevitable. A team that responds is not.

3 **A self-paced course with a live series runs on two clocks.**

The course is deliberately asynchronous: the material stands alone and participants set their own pace, which is right for operators fitting study around running infrastructure. The four live sessions ran to a fixed calendar, which implied a pace the course does not impose. One participant worked four modules in the final week to meet a deadline that was never really there. Signpost which modules a session draws on, and let the operator decide whether to be ahead of it.

4 **Written feedback under-reports.**

Three of nine responded in writing. The verbal round in the final session surfaced four themes the form missed entirely, including the strongest product ask of the project, a credentials package operators can show to funders.

5 **Material written to teach a framework grows past what the work needs.**

Two respondents independently said the modules carry more words than the assignments require, and one said it read as machine-written. Length is not rigour.

6 **A free launch cohort gives no price signal.**

Nothing was charged, so the published prices remain untested.

Recommendations for future development

BEFORE A SECOND COHORT:

1. **Build one complete worked SPO business model, end to end, and make it the spine of the course rather than an appendix.** This was the clearest single ask.
2. **Cut the overlapping frameworks.** Teach one model per idea and cross-reference the rest.
3. **Signpost rather than schedule.** Say which modules each live session draws on, so a participant can choose where to be without the course becoming a timetable.
4. **Restructure the live hour as application, not re-presentation,** and give it a written participation route for operators who would rather not speak.
5. **Clear the production debt:** audio quality, narration pace, contrast in module 503, image sizing in module 100, and hyperlinked cross-references.

BEYOND THAT:

6. **Build the credentials package.** The cohort asked for a logbook they can put in front of partners and funders. A per-module credential nobody outside the platform can read is worth less than the same credential in a document an operator can send.
7. **Charge the second cohort,** to test the pricing adopted in October.
8. **Work the platform feedback into Andamio's roadmap** in a dedicated session rather than as individual tickets.

SUPPORTING DOCUMENTS

- Cohort feedback report
- Improvements and action plan
- Pricing strategy and pricing market research
- Session write-ups and recordings: onboarding, session 1, session 2, session 3, session 4
- Milestone 4 EoMC

The course works.

Operators who finished it think differently about their pools and have a plan they say they will use, which is the outcome the proposal was funded for. What this cohort proved is that the hard part is not teaching operators business, it is getting them to commit the hours.

That is a product problem, and it has answers: a worked example instead of theory, a pace someone can follow, and a credential worth showing to someone else.

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